



1,500 apps vulnerable

New data from analytics service, SourceDNA, indicates that about 1,500 iOS apps are vulnerable to attack: <http://dgit.in/iOSbug>



Multi-coloured 3D printing

New 3D printer accessory from Palette makes it possible to 3D print multi-coloured objects <http://dgit.in/Palette3D>



Every month we recognize the best article written by our community members and publish it here. Keep up the good work, Digitians!

Save money while buying on e-commerce websites

Money, unfortunately, doesn't grow on trees and so we must spend it or save it wisely. This guide will help you do just that with every online purchase.



Praneet Sab

Whether it's locally or online, we all buy stuff. When it comes to buying things locally, nobody can bargain better than your experienced mother, however, even her skills won't help you save money online.

Get paid for your own purchases

Let's first understand what exactly an affiliate system is. Put simply, it means getting a commission on every purchase by buyers who are referred by you. It's the same as striking a deal with a local shop owner whose store you'll recommend to people and in exchange for your referral, for every purchase by these buyers, the store owner will give you some x% of money.

In general, websites like Flipkart would offer you somewhere between 0.1% and 20% commission on the total sales that were referred by you. The commission percentage is based on the category of the item that is bought. Categories such as Home Décor, Fashion and Toys generally offer more commission (going up to 20%), whereas categories such as Electronics tend to be lower paying (ranging from 0.1% to 10%). Multiple factors can affect the commission percentage and they're too many to list.

Now that you have a basic idea about how an affiliate system works, let's get on to creating an affiliate account (which is not the same as your normal shopping account). Once that's done, instead of referring other people to buy stuff, you'll refer yourself, buy the product, and get your cashback in the affiliate account. Since Flipkart is comparatively more popular, we'll guide you through this site's functions. You're free to choose any other e-commerce site also, and we're quite sure that the same trick would work there as well.

To take advantage of the system, all you need to do is to create an affiliate account at, say, <http://www.flipkart.com/affiliate/> (A Google search with keywords like "site's name + affiliate" can quickly give you the link to the affiliate page of any other e-commerce site). Check the FAQs and commission percentages, complete the registration, create an affiliate link and use that to make purchases on the site.

So that's how you use the affiliate system to your advantage, and the method isn't just limited to e-commerce – you can do the

same thing with other types of sites too. Just make sure that you aren't doing anything illegal and as usual, we won't be responsible if you get into trouble using this trick.

Score discounts online

At times, you may not wish to wait for a month in order to get your payouts. This is where coupon codes and deals come in handy. Getting your hands on coupon codes is much better than any deal. And the best thing is that coupon codes are available for a wide variety of websites (from shopping and food to travel and everything online). Interestingly, Flipkart doesn't accept coupons as of now and is entirely deal-based (and getting a good deal when you need it is very rare). The quickest way to find a great coupon site for your specific e-commerce site is to search with keywords like "site's name + coupons". This will definitely fetch



Taking advantage of affiliate programs can save you money.

you some good, reliable sites. Websites with a huge library of stores include www.coupondunia.in, www.couponraja.in and www.couponrani.com.

Apart from using a coupon, you may also consider comparing the price of the same product in multiple e-commerce stores. Previously, this may have been a tiring task but now we've got some great sites like jungle.com and buyhatke.com which can compare the prices for you. You can then pick the store which is the cheapest. 

Disclaimer: All opinions, tips and techniques expressed above are those of the author. Digit does not endorse or guarantee authenticity of the above claims. Proceed at your own risk.